Make the review easier to follow.

Parth Pawar · Formbricks #8650 · Final iteration · 26 October 2026

The brief was to make Change Stack easier to use without losing what it can do. I focused on reading the explanation, following the code and keeping track of the review. I reviewed the design with three developers through a mix of hands-on tasks and open feedback. Their feedback helped me revise the review flow. I haven't completed a controlled comparison or measured improvements.

Read before navigating

In the original, summary points shared a broad code range and expanding the summary also moved the diff. I separated those actions: expand to read, then follow a statement link. Full source wording and the whole function remain available. A precise highlight can hide surrounding logic, so I would check whether reviewers miss a branch.

Follow the change and return

Developers challenged the interrupted file flow and missing signals in my first version. I restored layer totals and recorded severity, and joined the files into one stream across seven layers. The original already scrolls continuously within a layer. Modified files retain equal Before/After panes; added files use full width. Inspect/Return restores the caller. The cost is keeping people oriented as they scroll.

Make progress deliberate

Feedback exposed too many competing counts. Viewed is now the main progress measure, with Undo; navigation and summary Seen remain separate. Findings retain severity beside resolution, so Major · Resolved reads as history. Message counts include replies. Range notes keep their file, side and lines. These states describe actions and captured history, not review quality.

Keep supporting tools useful

I compressed the reviewing controls to 92 px and made Overview a direct destination, with Return to review. Its layer table keeps source order; severity filters narrow the table only. A curated permission-check path offers a starting point. Light, Dark and System are optional preferences. Theme changes preserve position and drafts; dark colors are derived from the product palette.

Limits of this prototype

All 52 pinned diffs, layer membership and the comparison base are verified. Summary and thread coverage is partial; statement links are manually mapped. The captured access finding has two unavailable reply bodies. Secondary tools remain previews. This revision extends the Saturday submission and exceeded the original 1–2 hour brief.

The next evidence

Next I'd compare the same permission-review task in both versions: explain the checks, inspect the guard, return and leave a range note. I'd vary which version comes first and record missed checks, lost position and help needed.

Pinned commit 23cdac2d791c · Paper requires sign-in · Notes and progress stay in your browser.